Godot game - design document

Game Identity / Mantra:

Project Type: Indie Game Prototype / Portfolio Project

A 2D side on game where a museum security guard must use his flashlight and solve puzzles to survive a night among living exhibits.

Design Pillars:

Exploration, Survival, Tension

Core gameplay loop

- Explore: The player explores the museum to discover objectives, keys, switches, and locked areas.
- Discover: The player identifies tasks that must be completed, such as repairing the generator or restoring electricity.
- Encounter: Ghosts appear and begin chasing the player.
- Survive: The player uses the flashlight to stop enemies temporarily while managing its limited battery.
- Complete Objectives: The player solves puzzles and activates important mechanisms to progress.
- Progress: Completing objectives allows the player to access new areas and move closer to surviving the night.

Genre/Story/Mechanics Summary:

- The player takes the role of a security guard working the night shift at a museum.
- During the night, the guard discovers that some of the museum's exhibits come to life whenever they are not being watched. The player must survive until the end of the night while completing different tasks around the museum.
- The main gameplay mechanic is the **flashlight**. Ghosts cannot move while they are being illuminated by the flashlight, giving the player a way to temporarily stop them.
- However, the flashlight has limited battery, so the player must use it carefully.
- The museum contains different puzzles and objectives, such as repairing the generator, restoring electricity, finding keys and activating switches.
- Completing these objectives allows the player to survive through the night.
- As the player progresses through the nights, new and more dangerous ghost types are introduced.

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- The player loses if a ghost catches them.
- The goal is to survive the night and escape the museum.

Flashlight rules

- The flashlight is aimed with the mouse and activated while the left mouse button is held.
- The beam has a defined angle and maximum range. A ghost is immobilised only while it is inside the illuminated beam and has a clear line of sight to the light source.
- When the ghost is no longer illuminated, it resumes its normal movement immediately.
- Battery drains only while the flashlight is active.
    - This is a binary rule: illuminated = frozen; not illuminated = able to move.

Example puzzle Restore power

- The player reaches the generator room and finds that the generator cannot be started because its fuse is missing.
- A short interaction prompt explains: “Fuse missing — find a replacement.” The player must search an adjacent storage room.
- The replacement fuse is visible on a shelf or inside an unlocked cabinet. The player approaches it and presses E to collect it.
- The player returns to the generator. Interacting with the fuse panel installs the fuse.
- The player interacts with the generator switch to restore power. The room lights turn on and a nearby electrically locked door becomes usable.

Other objective types

- Find a key and use it on a clearly marked locked door.
- Activate a switch to open a gate or turn on a light in another room.
- Locate a fuse or replacement part and install it in a machine.

Features:

- 2D exploration.
- Flashlight-based ghost mechanic.
- Ghosts stop moving when illuminated.
- Limited flashlight battery.
- Different ghost types with unique behaviors.
- Puzzle-based objectives.
- Locked areas that require keys or switches.
- Simple progression system.

Interface:

Controls

- W / A / S / D – Move the character.
- Mouse – Aim the flashlight.
- Left Mouse Button – Use the flashlight.

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- E – Interact with objects.
- ESC – Pause the game.

Interactions

The player interacts with the environment by approaching objects and pressing the interaction button. Examples include repairing the generator, opening doors, collecting keys, and activating switches.

MVP:

The first playable version should include:

Player

- A controllable 2D character.
- Basic movement in four directions.
- Collision with the environment.

Flashlight

- Mouse-based flashlight aiming.
- Flashlight activation and deactivation.
- A visible flashlight effect or detection area.
- A battery system that decreases while the flashlight is active.
- Enemies must stop moving when illuminated.

Enemies

- At least one functional ghost type.
- Basic enemy movement and player detection.
- Enemy chasing behaviour.
- Player defeat when caught by an enemy.

Environment

- One playable museum area.
- Basic walls, rooms, and obstacles.
- Top-down camera.
- Basic lighting and atmosphere.

Objectives and Interactions

- At least one key and locked door.
- At least one switch or interactive object.
- One objective is that the player has to restore power or repair the generator.
- A functional interaction system.

Game flow and interface

- Title/start screen, pause screen, battery indicator, game-over state
- Basic sound cues for enemy detection, flashlight use, interaction, generator activation

Music/Sound:

Ambient sounds, environment sounds

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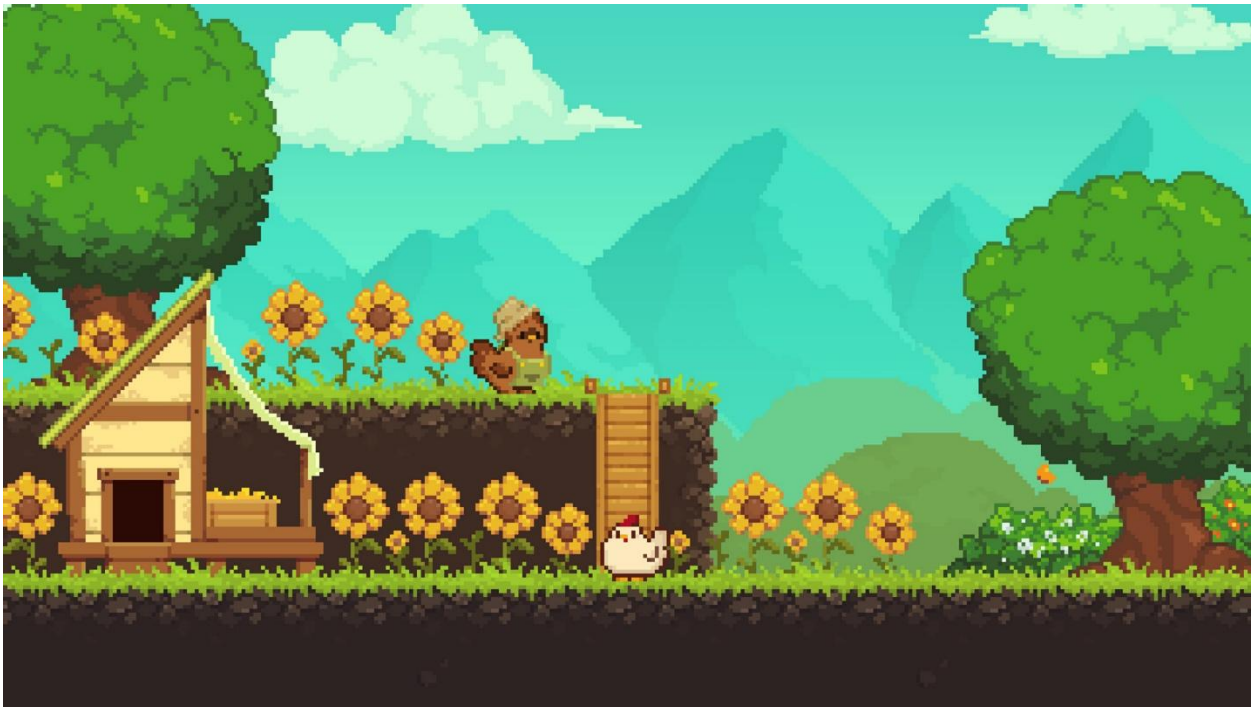
Art bible:

View

The game will be 2D Side-on perspective like the pictures below.

To see how the perspective will be





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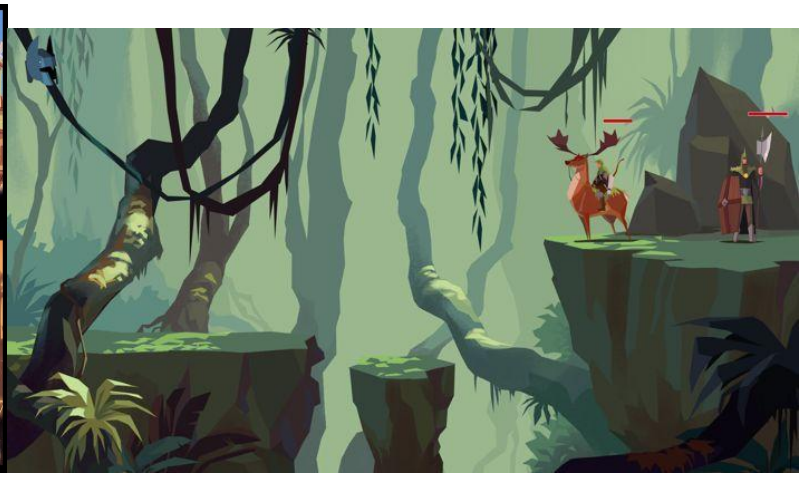
Style

With the style being stylized, like the pictures below.

Overall theme for characters,objects, rooms







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GAME DEV UNDERGROUND

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